ENGLISH

This section contains 22 questions.
The time allotted is 20 minutes.

The following section contains three types of questions: Sentence Completion, Restatement and Reading Comprehension. Each question is followed by four possible responses. Choose the response **which best answers the question** and mark its number in the appropriate place on the answer sheet.

Sentence Completions (Questions 1-8)
This part consists of sentences with a word or words missing in each. For each question, choose the answer **which best completes the sentence**.

1. Many libraries use the Dewey decimal system of classification to ____ the books in their collections.

(1) catalogue
(2) dissolve
(3) liberate
(4) supplement

---

2. "Venice is not an amusement park!" is the ____ used by residents protesting the negative effects of tourism on their city.

(1) riddle
(2) fiber
(3) cargo
(4) slogan

---

3. Carpal tunnel syndrome is a medical ____ which causes pain, numbness, and muscle weakness in the forearm and hand.

(1) experiment
(2) condition
(3) imitation
(4) arrangement

---

4. Albany, the capital of New York State, is ____ about 120 miles north of New York City.

(1) maintained
(2) situated
(3) illustrated
(4) contained

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

5. The Yongle Dadian, one of the earliest encyclopedias, ____ the 15th century.

(1) keeps up with
(2) dates back to
(3) makes up for
(4) turns away from

---

6. John Burnham Schwartz's 1998 novel, *Reservation Road*, was acclaimed by critics and readers ____.

(1) apart
(2) alone
(3) again
(4) alike

---

7. Today's fast-paced world leaves people little time for quiet ____.

(1) rejection
(2) reflection
(3) repetition
(4) restriction

---

8. Because the two continents of Europe and Asia form a ____ landmass, they are referred to jointly as Eurasia.

(1) single
(2) severe
(3) similar
(4) stubborn

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

Restatements (Questions 9-12)
This part consists of several sentences, each followed by four possible ways of restating the main idea of that sentence in different words. For each question, choose the one restatement **which best expresses the meaning of the original sentence**.

9. "A ship in the harbor is safe, but that is not what ships are built for." (John Shedd)

(1) One must plan a journey carefully in order to arrive safely.
(2) To fulfill one's potential, one must be willing to take risks.
(3) Many people do not know how to pursue their dreams.
(4) Some people seek adventure, while others prefer a quiet life.

---

10. Scientists Richard Feynman and Tim Flannery describe the universe in lucid, eloquent prose.

(1) Feynman and Flannery have unlocked many of the secrets of the universe.
(2) Feynman and Flannery's writings on the universe are clear and well expressed.
(3) Feynman and Flannery are respected scientists as well as gifted writers.
(4) Feynman and Flannery manage to make science interesting and even fun.

---

11. Chinese poet Mei Sheng is credited with the introduction of the five-character poetic line.

(1) Mei Sheng's innovative poetic techniques, which include the five-character line, have been adopted by many Chinese poets.
(2) Mei Sheng favored such poetic devices as the five-character line.
(3) Mei Sheng is considered the first poet to have used the five-character line.
(4) Mei Sheng used the five-character line more effectively than any other Chinese poet.

---

12. Despite two decades of rapidly declining world food prices, the percentage of people in developing countries who are malnourished remains high.

(1) During the past two decades, food prices have fallen in some parts of the world, but they remain high in many poor countries.
(2) As a result of declining food prices over the past 20 years, fewer people in developing countries are malnourished.
(3) While food prices throughout the world have fallen during the past 20 years, there are still many people in poor countries who do not have enough to eat.
(4) Despite the fact that world food prices have declined over the last two decades, malnutrition in developing countries has actually increased.

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

Reading Comprehension

This part consists of two passages, each followed by several related questions. For each question, **choose the most appropriate answer based on the text**.

Text I (Questions 13-17)

(1) Kung-fu-tzu, or Confucius, founded the Chinese philosophy of Confucianism. Confucius was born in 551 BCE in the city-state of Lu in northern China and died in 479 BCE. Not much is known about his early life, but it is thought that his rich and aristocratic family lost its status and became poor.

(5) When Confucius was young, the political situation in China was unstable. Although he held various official positions at the beginning of his career, Confucius eventually decided to become a teacher in order to educate future leaders. He attracted a large number of students with whom he discussed the moral, social, and political problems of the day.

(10) Confucius taught his students by encouraging debate, not by lecturing them. He emphasized the importance of *Li*, which might be translated as proper behavior or good manners. Confucius's ideal person was serious, respectful to superiors, and polite to strangers. Confucius believed that it was a son's duty not only to take care of his parents, but also to respect his ancestors. After Confucius died, his students continued (15) to spread his ideas. His teachings and philosophy have deeply influenced East Asian life.

For hundreds of years, Confucianism was widely followed in China. It was viewed as a way of life, a code of moral and social behavior, rather than a religion. Therefore, many people followed the teachings of Confucius while at the same time practicing a (20) religion such as Buddhism or Christianity. After the Communist revolution of 1949, Confucianism was banned by China's rulers, who believed that it would prevent social progress and change. In 1962, however, the Communist government changed its policy and the practice of Confucianism was permitted once again.

Questions

13. In the second paragraph, the author explains -

(1) why Confucius became a teacher
(2) why the political situation in China was unstable
(3) how students were educated in China
(4) how Confucius became interested in politics

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

14. The main purpose of the third paragraph is to -

(1) explain why Confucius had so many followers
(2) discuss some of Confucius's teachings
(3) describe Confucius's method of debating
(4) discuss attitudes towards Confucius's ideas

---

15. It can be inferred from the third paragraph that a person who practiced *Li* -

(1) was polite and respectful towards others
(2) actively spread Confucius's teachings
(3) wanted to become a philosopher
(4) recognized the importance of education

---

16. According to the last paragraph, many people in China followed a religion as well as the teachings of Confucius because -

(1) this was encouraged by the Communist government
(2) they thought Confucianism would lead to social progress and change
(3) they did not consider Confucianism a religion
(4) Confucius's students had encouraged this practice

---

17. An appropriate title for this text would be -

(1) Confucius: Politician or Philosopher?
(2) A Great Teacher and His Philosophy
(3) Different Religions in China
(4) The Influence of Confucianism on Communism

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

Text II (Questions 18-22)

Thomas Talhelm, today an associate professor of behavioral science at the University of Chicago, studies how culture affects human behavior. While living in China from 2007 to 2012, Talhelm became aware of differences in the traits and behaviors of people from different regions. He soon realized something that the Chinese themselves had long known: China's largest river, the Yangtze, serves not only as a geographical barrier, but also as a cultural divide. People who live south of the river are thought to be more cooperative and community oriented, while people who live north of the river are perceived as being more assertive and self-sufficient.

Talhelm posited that these particular characteristics could be traced to the primary agricultural crop grown in each region. Rice – southern China's staple crop – is grown in flooded fields called paddies. Neighboring farmers must flood, and later drain, their paddies at the same time to avoid causing significant damage to one another's fields. Lack of cooperation endangers everyone's livelihood. In contrast, the main crop in northern China is wheat. Wheat farming does not generally require much collaboration. One family can plant, tend, and harvest a field of wheat without the help of others.

Talhelm and his colleagues conducted a study to test the validity of his proposition, later referred to as "rice theory". They administered a series of psychological tests to 1,162 university students, some from cities north of the Yangtze River and some from cities south of the river. The tests measured personal qualities such as individualism and loyalty. The study, published in 2014, found that rice farming fosters interdependence, whereas wheat farming fosters independence. Interestingly, these characteristics were evident even when the students were not from families that currently farm rice or wheat. The study concluded that it is the multi-generational heritage of rice or wheat farming rather than one's current experience that shapes behavior and mindset. As Talhelm notes, "Cultures that farm rice or wheat over thousands of years pass on rice or wheat cultures, even after most people put down their plows."

Questions

18. The main purpose of the text is to -

(1) present Talhelm's rice theory
(2) describe a study on individualism in China
(3) discuss the Yangtze River's influence on agricultural practices
(4) present geographical characteristics north and south of the Yangtze River

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.

19. According to the first paragraph, people in China regard those who live north of the Yangtze River as -

(1) less culturally diverse than people south of the river
(2) isolated from the rest of China
(3) friendly and welcoming
(4) more independent than those who live south of the river

---

20. Which of the following words from the second paragraph means something different from the others?

(1) particular
(2) primary
(3) staple
(4) main

---

21. The main purpose of the last paragraph is to -

(1) compare wheat cultures and rice cultures
(2) describe how Talhelm showed that people's traits are shaped by the agricultural traditions of their families
(3) explain why Talhelm's theory came to be called "rice theory"
(4) describe how Talhelm and his colleagues conducted their study of university students

---

22. It can be inferred from the last paragraph that in China today -

(1) many people who live in cities come from families that once farmed
(2) most farming families no longer send their children to university
(3) rice theory is no longer accepted
(4) loyalty is valued more than individualism

© כל הזכויות שמורות למרכז ארצי לבחינות ולהערכה (ע"ר)
אין להעתיק או להפיץ בחינה זו או קטעים ממנה בכל צורה ובכל אמצעי, או ללמדה – כולה או חלקים ממנה – בלא אישור בכתב מהמרכז הארצי לבחינות ולהערכה.